



House of Representatives

General Assembly

File No. 184

February Session, 2026

Substitute House Bill No. 5223

House of Representatives, March 26, 2026

The Committee on General Law reported through REP. LEMAR of the 96th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the House, that the substitute bill ought to pass.

AN ACT ESTABLISHING A TASK FORCE TO STUDY ISSUES CONCERNING GROCERY STORE BEER PERMITS.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

- 1 Section 1. (*Effective from passage*) (a) There is established a task force
- 2 to study issues concerning grocery store beer permits. Such study shall
- 3 include, but need not be limited to, an examination of (1) the feasibility
- 4 of establishing a per capita cap on the number of grocery store beer
- 5 permits that may be issued within a municipality, and (2) the criteria
- 6 applied to assess eligibility for a grocery store beer permit.
- 7 (b) The task force shall consist of the following members:
- 8 (1) Two appointed by the speaker of the House of Representatives;
- 9 (2) Two appointed by the president pro tempore of the Senate;
- 10 (3) One appointed by the majority leader of the House of
- 11 Representatives;

- 12 (4) One appointed by the majority leader of the Senate;
- 13 (5) One appointed by the minority leader of the House of
14 Representatives;
- 15 (6) One appointed by the minority leader of the Senate;
- 16 (7) One appointed by the House chairperson of the joint standing
17 committee of the General Assembly having cognizance of matters
18 relating to consumer protection;
- 19 (8) One appointed by the Senate chairperson of the joint standing
20 committee of the General Assembly having cognizance of matters
21 relating to consumer protection;
- 22 (9) One appointed by the House ranking member of the joint standing
23 committee of the General Assembly having cognizance of matters
24 relating to consumer protection;
- 25 (10) One appointed by the Senate ranking member of the joint
26 standing committee of the General Assembly having cognizance of
27 matters relating to consumer protection;
- 28 (11) The Commissioner of Consumer Protection, or the
29 commissioner's designee; and
- 30 (12) Two appointed by the Governor.
- 31 (c) Any member of the task force appointed under subdivision (1),
32 (2), (3), (4), (5), (6), (7), (8), (9) or (10) of subsection (b) of this section may
33 be a member of the General Assembly.
- 34 (d) All initial appointments to the task force shall be made not later
35 than thirty days after the effective date of this section. Any vacancy shall
36 be filled by the appointing authority.
- 37 (e) The speaker of the House of Representatives and the president pro
38 tempore of the Senate shall select the chairpersons of the task force from
39 among the members of the task force. Such chairpersons shall schedule

40 the first meeting of the task force, which shall be held not later than sixty
41 days after the effective date of this section.

42 (f) The administrative staff of the joint standing committee of the
43 General Assembly having cognizance of matters relating to consumer
44 protection shall serve as administrative staff of the task force.

45 (g) Not later than January 1, 2027, the task force shall submit a report
46 on its findings and recommendations to the joint standing committee of
47 the General Assembly having cognizance of matters relating to
48 consumer protection, in accordance with the provisions of section 11-4a
49 of the general statutes. The task force shall terminate on the date that it
50 submits such report or January 1, 2027, whichever is later.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>from passage</i>	New section

Statement of Legislative Commissioners:

In Subsec. (c), "subdivisions (1) to (10), inclusive," was changed to "subdivision (1), (2), (3), (4), (5), (6), (7), (8), (9) or (10)" for accuracy.

GL *Joint Favorable Subst. -LCO*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note**State Impact:** None**Municipal Impact:** None**Explanation**

The bill creates a task force to study issues concerning grocery store beer permits resulting in no fiscal impact to the state as the task force has the expertise to meet the requirements of the bill.

The Out Years**State Impact:** None**Municipal Impact:** None

OLR Bill Analysis

HB 5223

***AN ACT ESTABLISHING A TASK FORCE TO STUDY ISSUES
CONCERNING GROCERY STORE BEER PERMITS.***

SUMMARY

The Office of Legislative Research does not analyze Special Acts.

COMMITTEE ACTION

General Law Committee

Joint Favorable

Yea 20 Nay 0 (03/11/2026)